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POLS202

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Post Class Assignment 1: Presidential Candidate Policy

Candidate:	Housing	Climate Change	Education	Civil Rights
Sources	(Schneid, 2024)	(NBC News Staff, 2024) (Luhby & Mullery, 2024)	(Blackburn, Turner, Mullery, & Uzquiano, 2024)	(Blackburn, Turner, Mullery, & Uzquiano, 2024) (Wang, 2024)
Harris	• Increasing low-income tax credit • $25k in down payment assistance • Increase supply (? vague)	• Paris climate agreement ○ Tax credits/ spending • Green new deal • (reversed position on fracking)	• Student debt relief	• Freedom to vote act
Trump	• Regulation reduction • Repurposing federal land • Reducing immigration to lower prices (no evidence)	• Climate change is a non-issue • Reduce regulation ○ Increase energy supply	• Remove DOE to "leave it to states" • Abolish k-12 tenure • Fine teaching CRT or gender education	• Plans to gut justice dept. • Voting restrictions ○ Restriction mail ballots

2. What is one misleading claim about inflation or the economy that has been a talking point in this election?

An economic lie in this election has been the smearing the cause of inflation onto the opposing candidate, with Trump touting that the record high inflation rate of 9% under the Biden administration was caused by the democrats, while Harris claims that Trump's spending in office is to blame. However, economists themselves argue about the cause of inflation whether stemming from supply-chain issues presented during covid to rampant

consumption after the economic stimulus (Sonnenfeld & Henriques, 2024). Instead of trying to smear each other regarding the cause of the economic state of this country they should try to provide plausible solutions that resonate with voters.

3. **Why, do you think is this a close race according to the polls?**

   I think this is a close presidential race because not only is our political scene increasingly polarized, but the messaging about politics has gotten very one-sided "if you're not with us, you're with them" mentality. This has lead to people choosing a candidate to represent them which doesn't necessarily share their views and vehemently sticking to their guns causing a close race once more tiring the population with politics.

4. **Which ideology does each of the two major candidates represent? No name calling, I'm looking for a somewhat sober ideological analysis.**

   As far as I am aware: President Trump supports laissez-faire economic policy with lax regulation leaving choices to corporations or states, while strictly resonating with conservative "anti-woke" rhetoric. Harris on the other hand is tricky to pinpoint although supporting the policies of the liberal wing of democrats, her career as a prosecutor makes her seem like a "law-and-order" candidate, which is why it could make sense why she is trying to present herself as a moderate willing to work with republicans.

5. **Why does the amount of money that each candidate raised for campaigning matter?**

   The amount of money each candidate raised for their campaign matters because it is a gauge of power, it establishes how a candidate and campaign message voters in ads, rallies, and interviews. Outside of that it could also show how popular a candidate is based on how many people donate to their campaign of their own volition.

Works Cited

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